WALL STREET
ALPHA

PRIVATE CREDIT RECRUITING GUIDE

Funds That Hire Undergraduates
+ Recruiting Timelines

2026–2027 Edition

WALL STREET ALPHA | BY CHASE ENLOE

How Private Credit Recruiting Actually Works

Private credit recruiting is less standardized than investment banking. Some large alternative managers run formal campus programs. Other lenders hire only a handful of analysts, post roles inconsistently, or recruit through a parent company. The strongest candidates combine early application monitoring with targeted networking.



THE MOST IMPORTANT RULE

Start before the posting appears. For junior-summer roles, build your resume, technical foundation and networking list during sophomore fall. Several elite firms begin accepting applications during sophomore spring for internships that start more than a year later.



HOW TO READ THE DIRECTORY

Official timeline published means the firm has publicly described a recruiting window. Recurring campus hiring means the firm regularly hires students but exact credit-team openings can change. Team-specific means students should monitor the official portal and network because the role may not appear every year.



WHO THIS GUIDE IS FOR

Undergraduates targeting direct lending, opportunistic credit, specialty finance, asset-based lending, private placements, distressed credit or broader alternatives roles that can lead into private credit.



A PRACTICAL WARNING

Do not limit your search to jobs titled 'Private Credit Summer Analyst.' Relevant roles may be posted as Credit Analyst, Direct Lending Analyst, Private Capital Analyst, Alternative Credit Analyst, Investment Analyst, Specialty Finance Analyst or simply Summer Analyst within an asset-management platform.

The Recruiting Calendar

When	What usually happens	What you should do
August–October	Many banks, asset managers and some alternative platforms open next-summer applications.	Apply immediately, set alerts and begin alumni outreach before interview volume accelerates.
November–December	Some smaller funds post roles; large-firm processes may continue or close.	Follow up with contacts, improve credit technicals and widen the target list.
January–March	A critical early-cycle window. Blackstone says campus roles may appear Jan–Mar; KKR has historically opened summer applications in January.	Check portals weekly. Be ready for accelerated HireVue, first rounds and superdays.
April–June	Late-cycle and smaller-team openings appear; networking-driven opportunities become more important.	Target lean funds, regional lenders, BDCs, insurance platforms and specialty-finance teams.
Year-round	Off-cycle internships, school-year roles and ad hoc analyst needs can surface at smaller firms.	Keep alerts active and maintain relationships even after major programs close.

Recommended monitoring system

Create a spreadsheet with each firm, career-page link, target office, application status, networking contacts and last-checked date. Set a recurring calendar reminder to review the full list every Monday during peak recruiting months.

Private Credit Fund Directory

Timing is a monitoring window, not a guaranteed opening date. Click a firm name to visit its career page.

Fund / Platform	Likely Undergraduate Channel	When to monitor	Evidence / Note
Blackstone Credit & Insurance	Summer Analyst / full-time Analyst through campus programs	Jan–Mar; interviews can begin in Feb for the following year	Official timeline published
KKR Credit	Summer Analyst and full-time Analyst across asset management	Jan–Feb is a key watch period; apply during sophomore spring for junior summer	Official student program; timing historically early
Apollo Global Management	Summer Analyst roles across investment strategies, including credit	Fall for the upcoming summer; monitor Aug–Oct	Officially states roles post in fall
Ares Management	Summer Analyst / Analyst roles across Credit and other strategies	Begin monitoring Jan–Mar and again Aug–Oct	Recurring campus hiring; exact team openings vary
Oaktree Capital Management	Investment-team and corporate internships; credit-focused platform	Monitor late summer through fall, plus Jan–Mar	Official internship program; team mix varies
Blue Owl Capital	Analyst and internship openings across Direct Lending and other platforms	Monitor year-round; strongest watch windows Jan–Mar and Aug–Oct	Openings vary by team and office
Golub Capital	Internship and entry-level roles at a dedicated direct lender	Monitor Aug–Nov and Jan–Mar	Official careers channel; exact campus dates vary
Antares Capital	Summer internships and analyst hiring in middle-market direct lending	Monitor Aug–Nov; check again Jan–Mar	Historically hires early-career talent
Sixth Street	Summer Analyst / early-career roles across investing strategies	Monitor Jan–Mar and Aug–Oct	Selective openings; role names vary
Carlyle Global Credit	Summer Analyst / Analyst through Carlyle campus recruiting	Monitor Jan–Mar for next-year summer roles	Broader campus program can include credit teams

Private Credit Fund Directory (continued)

Fund / platform	Likely undergraduate channel	When to monitor	Evidence / note
TPG Angelo Gordon	Investment internships and analyst roles across credit strategies	Monitor Jan–Mar and Aug–Oct	Team-specific openings
Bain Capital Credit	Summer and full-time Analyst opportunities through campus recruiting	Monitor Jan–Mar; networking should start in prior fall	Highly selective, team-specific
Fortress Investment Group	Internships and analyst roles across credit and real assets	Monitor Aug–Nov and Jan–Mar	Openings vary materially by strategy
HPS Investment Partners	Analyst and occasional internship opportunities in private credit	Monitor year-round, especially Aug–Oct and Jan–Mar	Lean hiring; networking is especially important
Crescent Capital Group	Internships and analyst opportunities in below-investment-grade credit	Monitor Aug–Nov and Jan–Mar	Smaller classes; openings may be less standardized
Benefit Street Partners	Credit investment roles within Franklin Templeton alternatives	Monitor Franklin Templeton student and experienced-hire portals year-round	May recruit under broader parent platform
Churchill Asset Management / Nuveen	Internships and analyst roles in middle-market private capital	Monitor Nuveen/TIAA campus hiring Aug–Nov and Jan–Mar	Often posted through parent-company channels
Monroe Capital	Internship and analyst roles in middle-market direct lending	Monitor Aug–Nov and Jan–Mar	Smaller intake; proactive outreach helps
MidCap Financial	Early-career roles in specialty and middle-market lending	Monitor year-round, particularly Aug–Oct	Openings may be posted through Apollo-related channels
Audax Private Debt	Analyst opportunities in sponsor finance and middle-market credit	Monitor Jan–Mar and Aug–Oct	Lean teams; internships may vary by year

Private Credit Fund Directory
(continued)

Fund / platform	Likely undergraduate channel	When to monitor	Evidence / note
BlackRock Private Debt	Summer Analyst / Analyst via BlackRock student programs	Applications often open in late summer or early fall	Apply to broader alternatives / private markets postings
Goldman Sachs Asset Management – Private Credit	Summer Analyst / New Analyst through firmwide campus recruiting	Applications commonly open in summer or early fall	Search Asset Management and alternatives roles
J.P. Morgan Asset Management – Private Capital	Summer Analyst / full-time Analyst through firmwide programs	Monitor late summer through fall	Private-credit exposure may sit within broader AM roles
Morgan Stanley Investment Management – Private Credit	Summer Analyst / full-time Analyst through campus recruiting	Monitor Aug–Oct	Team placement and openings vary
PIMCO Alternatives / Private Credit	Summer internships and full-time analyst programs	Monitor Aug–Oct, with some roles earlier	Search alternatives, credit research and portfolio roles
Barings Private Credit	Internships and analyst roles across global private finance	Monitor Aug–Nov and Jan–Mar	Regional and team-specific hiring
PGIM Private Capital	Investment Analyst programs and internships in private placements/private credit	Monitor late summer through fall	Strong direct-from-undergrad pathway
AllianceBernstein Private Credit Investors	Summer and full-time analyst opportunities through AB programs	Monitor Aug–Nov and Jan–Mar	Openings can sit under private alternatives
Neuberger Berman Private Debt	Summer internships and analyst roles through campus recruiting	Monitor Aug–Nov	Search private markets / alternatives roles
Kayne Anderson Private Credit	Internships and analyst roles across private credit strategies	Monitor year-round; strongest windows Aug–Oct and Jan–Mar	Smaller classes; networking is important

How to Build a Winning Target List

Use a three-bucket strategy instead of applying only to famous mega-funds.

Bucket	Examples	Target allocation
Large alternative managers	Blackstone, KKR, Apollo, Ares, Oaktree, Carlyle, Blue Owl	25% of outreach and applications
Dedicated direct lenders	Golub, Antares, Monroe, Churchill, Crescent, Audax Private Debt	45%
Asset managers and insurance platforms	PGIM, Barings, BlackRock, PIMCO, Neuberger Berman, AB	30%

Networking message that works

Keep the ask focused on learning, not requesting an interview. Reference the person's specific team, ask how the underwriting process differs from banking, and request 15 minutes. After the call, send a concise thank-you and remain in touch when applications open.

What firms test

Expect accounting, three-statement mechanics, enterprise value, leverage and coverage ratios, debt sizing, credit documents, downside cases, recovery analysis, industry risks and an investment recommendation. Some firms also use modeling tests or written credit memos.

Your one-minute private credit answer

Be able to explain why you prefer downside protection, contractual returns, cash-flow underwriting and capital-structure analysis. Avoid saying private credit is simply 'private equity with fewer hours.' Demonstrate genuine interest in lending and risk assessment.

Private Credit Recruiting Checklist

1. Build a 40–60 firm target list across mega-funds, dedicated lenders and asset managers.
2. Set job alerts for Private Credit, Direct Lending, Private Capital, Credit Analyst and Investment Analyst.
3. Prepare a one-page resume with quantified finance, investing and leadership experience.
4. Learn accounting, leverage, coverage ratios, debt tranches, covenants, returns and downside analysis.
5. Complete at least two credit case studies and practice presenting a concise investment recommendation.
6. Network with analysts and associates before applications open, not only after submitting.
7. Apply within the first 24–72 hours whenever possible.
8. Track every application, contact, follow-up and interview question in one system.
9. Continue targeting investment banking, leveraged finance and corporate banking as strong feeder paths.

Want a personalized path from your current profile to a private credit offer?

Wall Street Alpha provides 1:1 recruiting strategy, networking execution, technical preparation, mock interviews and offer positioning.

Visit wallstalpha.com to apply

DISCLAIMER

This guide is educational and is not affiliated with or endorsed by any listed firm. Recruiting programs, eligibility rules, offices and dates can change without notice. Always verify current openings and requirements on the official career page before applying.

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Sources and Verification Notes

The guide prioritizes official firm career pages. Where a firm does not publish a fixed annual calendar, timing is presented as a recommended monitoring window based on recurring campus recruiting patterns, not as a guaranteed opening date.

1. **Blackstone Students**
   Official eligibility and timeline: campus positions can appear Jan–Mar; U.S. interviews begin in February for programs starting the following year.

2. **KKR Student Careers**
   Official undergraduate summer and full-time analyst pathways.

3. **Apollo Life at Apollo**
   Officially states available summer roles are posted in the fall for the upcoming summer.

4. **Oaktree Careers**
   Official careers page and evidence of undergraduate credit programming and internships.

5. **Golub Capital Careers**
   Official careers page for a dedicated private-credit manager.

6. **Company career pages listed in the directory**
   Used to identify recurring early-career channels. Exact annual openings must be rechecked live.

Last updated: July 15, 2026

Because recruiting changes quickly, update this guide at least quarterly and immediately after major firms publish a new campus cycle.